

24번

There are fundamental differences between our attention to animals and our attention to plants, and these are deeply embedded in our visual systems. One study used a core tool from visual cognition studies called "attentional blink." "Blink" is when the focus that is given to one object slows down our ability to engage with a new object. Our visual processing power is a finite resource, so the more attention the first object takes up, the slower we are to shift on to the second. In this study, one group of people were first shown an animal and another group were first shown a plant. A second object, a water droplet, followed in quick succession. Those looking at an animal initially were much less likely to see the water than those first looking at a plant. The plant simply took up less of their attention, freeing up capacity to notice other things. Plants are not only thought of as less interesting, they are fundamentally given less processing power in our visual system, becoming a mass of crowded, unmoving background greenery.